



Consumer Healthcare Division

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Consumer Healthcare - Order-to-Cash Standard Operating Procedure

Standard Operating Procedure | Sanofi Consumer Healthcare Division

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Document Status and Usage Notes

IMPORTANT - Document Status

This document (SCH-OPS-CS-SOP-001 v4.0) was effective for Sanofi Consumer Healthcare EMEA operations from 1 January 2023 until the Opella carve-out (April 2025). It is retained as a reference document only.

It is NOT authoritative for Opella operations. Opella's Order Management SOP (OPS-EU-CS-SOP-001 v2.1) supersedes this document for all Opella Europe order management activities. Personnel must not apply procedures from this document to Opella operations without CS Team Lead confirmation of applicability.

Document Control

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Version History (Sanofi)

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
4.0	01 Jan 2023	Sanofi CS Ops	Updated for SAP S/4HANA migration completed Q4 2022. EDI section (Section 11) expanded. EDI active connection list (Appendix A) updated.
3.2	01 Jun 2021	Sanofi CS Ops	EDI eligibility criteria revised. Priority EDI SLA table added.
3.0	01 Jan 2020	Sanofi CS Ops	Consolidated EMEA regional variants into single document.
2.0	01 Mar 2018	Sanofi CS Ops	Introduced central credit management model and single customer master.
1.0	01 Jan 2015	Sanofi CS Ops	Initial issue.

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1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) defines the end-to-end process for receiving, validating, confirming, and fulfilling customer orders within Sanofi Consumer Healthcare EMEA. It applies to all Customer Service, Credit Control, and Operations personnel involved in the Order-to-Cash process.

This document provides a single, consistent reference for all order management activities, covering manual, email, and Electronic Data Interchange (EDI) order channels. All three channels are documented with equal rigour; channel choice is determined by the customer's technical capability and the trading volume criteria in Section 6.3.

1.2 Scope

- All Consumer Healthcare customer orders from retail pharmacy chains, hospital buying groups, specialist wholesalers, and pharmacy multiples across the EMEA region.
- All three order channels: manual (telephone), email, and EDI.
- All customer accounts in the Sanofi global SAP S/4HANA instance with a Consumer Healthcare product range.
- All CS Representatives, CS Team Leads, EDI Integration Specialists, Credit Controllers, Account Managers, and DC Operations personnel in scope.

2. Business Model Context

Sanofi Consumer Healthcare operates a focused product portfolio in the self-care and OTC categories, distributed through retail pharmacy chains, hospital buying groups, and specialist wholesalers across EMEA. The order profile is characterised by:

- High-value, lower-frequency orders from major pharmacy chains and wholesalers, typically weekly or bi-weekly on agreed replenishment cycles.
- A growing proportion of EDI-based orders from accounts where the commercial relationship and order volume justify the technical investment in connectivity.
- A residual manual and email order base, principally from independent pharmacies and smaller specialist accounts.
- A very small number of fax orders from legacy accounts in certain markets, accepted under derogation from the standard channel policy.

At the time of this version (v4.0), EDI accounts for approximately 60% of total order volume by value across EMEA. The strategic direction is to expand EDI connectivity to further accounts that meet the eligibility criteria in Section 6.3, with a target of 75% EDI order volume by value by end of 2024.

3. Definitions and Abbreviations

Term	Definition
AM (Account Manager)	The commercial relationship owner for a customer account.
DESADV	Despatch Advice: EDIFACT message sent to the customer confirming that goods have been despatched, including shipment details.
EDI (Electronic Data Interchange)	The electronic exchange of standardised business documents (purchase orders, confirmations, invoices) between Sanofi and trading partners using the EDIFACT standard.
GLN (Global Location Number)	A unique identifier assigned to a trading location, used in EDI messages to identify the sender and receiver.
INVOIC	Invoice: EDIFACT message sent to the customer following despatch, constituting the formal invoice.
MOQ (Minimum Order Quantity)	The minimum quantity of a given SKU accepted per order line.
ORDERS	Purchase Order: EDIFACT message received from the trading partner containing the customer's purchase order.
ORDRSP	Order Response: EDIFACT message sent by Sanofi to confirm, amend, or reject a received ORDERS message.
SAP S/4HANA	Sanofi's global ERP system. The single source of truth for all customer accounts, credit limits, inventory, and order processing.
TSA	Transition Services Agreement: agreement under which Sanofi provides defined services to carve-out entities post-separation.
VAN (Value Added Network)	A third-party network provider that routes EDI messages between trading partners where direct AS2 connectivity is not in place.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility Summary
CS Representative	Day-to-day order processing across all channels (manual, email, EDI exception handling). First-line customer queries. Order confirmation and monitoring.
CS Team Lead	Team management and quality oversight. Second-level escalation. Process documentation. Monthly KPI reporting.
EDI Integration Specialist	Technical management of all EDI connections: onboarding new trading partners, monitoring connection health, resolving message failures, and liaising with Sanofi IT.
Credit Controller	Customer credit limit maintenance (SAP S/4HANA). Credit hold decisions and releases. Overdue collections. Monthly AR reporting.
Account Manager	Commercial relationship ownership. Credit review requests. EDI connectivity coordination. Strategic customer escalation.
Sanofi Shared Services - IT (EDI)	Platform management for EDI infrastructure (SAP Integration Suite). Tier 2 incident support. Trading partner technical onboarding.
DC Operations	Order fulfilment: pick, pack, despatch. Partial shipment notification. Short delivery investigation.

5. Customer Master Data

5.1 Single Source of Truth

All customer master data - including account status, credit limits, payment terms, price lists, delivery addresses, and EDI configuration - is maintained centrally in the Sanofi global SAP S/4HANA instance by Sanofi Shared Services Master Data. There is a single record per customer entity. Local market teams do not maintain separate customer records or credit limit overrides in any other system.

This single-record architecture ensures that the credit limit used for order release decisions is always current and consistent regardless of the order channel. CS Representatives performing order validation do not need to cross-check credit data across multiple systems.

5.2 Authorised Master Data Changes

All customer master data changes require submission through the Sanofi Master Data workflow in SAP S/4HANA. Changes are reviewed by Sanofi Shared Services Master Data before taking effect. Ad hoc manual updates outside the workflow are not permitted and will be reversed.

Credit limit changes specifically require Credit Management team approval (for standard limits) or European Credit Director approval (for limits above EUR 500,000 or for emergency intra-year increases above EUR 200,000). Account Managers do not have authority to modify credit limits.

6. Order Receipt

6.1 Approved Order Channels

Sanofi Consumer Healthcare EMEA accepts customer orders through three approved channels. The appropriate channel for each account is determined by the EDI eligibility criteria in Section 6.3 and is documented in the customer's SAP account record.

Channel	Description	Order Volume at Version 4.0
EDI	Fully automated order receipt via EDIFACT ORDERS message. Orders flow directly into SAP S/4HANA without manual intervention. Real-time ORDRSP confirmation returned.	Approximately 60% of order volume by value.
Email	Written orders received to the designated regional order mailbox. Manually entered into SAP by CS Representative within one business day.	Approximately 30% of order volume by value.
Manual / Telephone	Orders placed verbally and entered into SAP by CS Representative during or immediately after the call.	Approximately 10% of order volume by value.

6.2 Manual and Email Order Processing

The manual and email order processes follow standard CS procedures. The CS Representative is responsible for all validation steps in Section 7 before confirming the order to the customer.

1. Receipt: acknowledge receipt to the customer within two business hours of order arrival (telephone: immediate; email: written acknowledgement).
2. Information capture: confirm all required order details (account number, SKU(s), quantities, delivery address, customer PO reference, requested delivery date).
3. SAP entry: enter the order in SAP S/4HANA. For telephone orders: within 30 minutes of call end. For email orders: within one business day of receipt.
4. Validation: complete all steps in Section 7.
5. Confirmation: issue formal confirmation within the timelines in Section 8.

6.3 EDI Order Processing

EDI orders arrive in SAP S/4HANA automatically via the Sanofi EDI platform (SAP Integration Suite). Under standard conditions, EDI orders pass through the automated validation rules in SAP without CS intervention and are confirmed via an automated ORDRSP message.

The CS Representative is responsible for monitoring the EDI order queue for exception messages: orders that have failed automated validation and require manual intervention. Exceptions are flagged in the SAP worklist and must be resolved within four business hours of appearing.

6.4 EDI Eligibility Criteria

EDI connectivity is available to accounts that meet the following criteria:

- Annual order value with Sanofi Consumer Healthcare exceeding EUR 5 million at current or projected run

rate.

- Order frequency of at least three purchase orders per week on a regular cadence.
- Dedicated EDI technical capability at the trading partner (internal EDI team or third-party VAN provider).
- Willingness to complete Sanofi's EDI onboarding and testing process, including a minimum of three full message cycle tests before going live.

EDI connectivity is available as a service for accounts below the EUR 5M threshold where the Account Manager makes a business case and the EDI Integration Specialist confirms technical feasibility. Such cases require VP Consumer Healthcare Operations approval.

7. Order Validation

All orders - regardless of channel - must pass the following validation sequence before confirmation. EDI orders are validated automatically by SAP S/4HANA rules; exceptions require manual CS intervention. Manual and email orders are validated by the CS Representative in SAP.

Validation Step	EDI (Automated)	Manual / Email (CS Rep)
Account status check	SAP rule: blocks ORDRSP if account not Active.	CS Rep verifies account status in SAP before entry.
Credit limit check	SAP rule: places order on credit hold if limit exceeded.	CS Rep checks outstanding balance + order value vs. limit.
Product availability	SAP rule: flags exception if DC stock < ordered quantity.	CS Rep checks DC inventory in SAP.
MOQ compliance	SAP rule: flags exception if quantity < MOQ.	CS Rep verifies MOQ before entry.
Pricing validation	SAP rule: flags exception if price deviates > 1% from price list.	CS Rep confirms price list reference with AM if discrepancy found.

8. Order Confirmation

8.1 Confirmation Methods by Channel

Channel	Confirmation Method	Timeline
EDI	Automated ORDRSP message sent directly to the trading partner's EDI platform within 30 minutes of order receipt (automated SAP process). Exception ORDRSP (accepting with amendments) sent within 2 hrs of exception resolution.	30 minutes (automated); 2 hrs (exceptions).
Email	Email reply to the original order email, attaching the SAP order confirmation as a PDF.	Within 2 business hours of SAP order entry.
Manual	Email to the customer's order contact, attaching SAP confirmation PDF. Verbal confirmation of key details at end of call.	Within 4 business hours of call.

9. Order Fulfilment and Despatch

9.1 Release to Distribution

Orders confirmed to customers are released automatically to the allocated Distribution Centre in SAP S/4HANA following successful credit and inventory validation. For EDI orders, release is automatic. For manual and email orders, the CS Representative releases the confirmed order in SAP.

9.2 Standard Lead Times

Market	Lead Time (Business Days)	Primary DC
France	2	Chartres, FR
United Kingdom	3	Reading, UK (Sanofi CS DC)
Germany	2	Frankfurt, DE
Spain / Portugal	3	Barcelona, ES
Benelux	2	Antwerp, BE
Italy	3	Milan, IT (3PL managed)
Rest of EMEA	3-5	Market-specific.

10. Invoicing

10.1 Invoice Generation

Invoices are generated automatically in SAP S/4HANA upon despatch confirmation from the DC. For EDI-enabled accounts, the invoice is also transmitted electronically as an INVOIC message via the EDI platform within one hour of SAP invoice generation. For non-EDI accounts, the invoice is dispatched by email as a PDF attachment.

10.2 Payment Terms

Account Type	Standard Payment Terms
Major Retail Pharmacy Chains	NET 45 days from invoice date.
Hospital Buying Groups	NET 45 days from invoice date.
Wholesalers	NET 30 days from invoice date.
Independent Pharmacies	NET 30 days from invoice date.

11. EDI Programme

11.1 Programme Overview

The EDI programme is a strategic initiative to maximise the proportion of Sanofi Consumer Healthcare orders transacted electronically. The programme is owned by the CS Operations function and delivered by the EDI Integration team in partnership with Sanofi Shared Services IT.

As of January 2023, 34 active EDI connections are live across the EMEA region, processing approximately 60% of order volume by value. The programme target is 75% by end of 2024, requiring the onboarding of approximately 8-10 additional accounts.

11.2 Active EDI Connections - EMEA (Selected)

The full EDI active connection list is maintained in the Sanofi Shared Services EDI Connection Register (Appendix A contains a representative extract). The register is maintained by the EDI Integration team and reviewed quarterly.

Market	Trading Partner	Messages	Annual Volume (EUF	Priority SLA
FR	Carrefour France	ORDERS/ORDRSP/INVOIC	38.2	4 hrs
FR	E.Leclerc	ORDERS/ORDRSP/DESAD	22.7	4 hrs
UK	Boots UK	ORDERS/ORDRSP/INVOIC	29.4	4 hrs
DE	dm (Drogerie Markt)	ORDERS/ORDRSP	16.8	8 hrs
DE	REWE Group	ORDERS/ORDRSP	11.2	8 hrs
EU	Lidl Europe	ORDERS/ORDRSP	18.9	4 hrs

UK	Tesco UK	ORDERS/ORDRSP/DESAD	24.1	4 hrs
EU	Alliance Healthcare	V/INVOIC ORDERS/DESADV	13.4	8 hrs

11.3 EDI Incident Management

EDI connection incidents are managed by the Sanofi IT helpdesk (EDI support line: contact details in Appendix B). The following SLAs apply:

Priority	Trigger	Response SLA	Resolution SLA
Priority 1	EDI connection fully down for an account with annual volume > EUR 10M.	30 minutes	4 business hours
Priority 2	Intermittent failures or message errors on any active EDI connection.	2 hours	1 business day
Priority 3	Non-urgent issues: mapping queries, configuration changes, new partner setup questions.	1 business day	5 business days

CS Representatives must not contact trading partner EDI teams directly for connection issues. All EDI incidents must be logged through the Sanofi IT helpdesk. The EDI Integration Specialist will manage the incident and provide regular status updates to the CS Team Lead.

11.4 EDI Onboarding for New Accounts

The EDI onboarding process for a new trading partner takes approximately 6-8 weeks from the date scoping is agreed. The Account Manager initiates onboarding by submitting the EDI Onboarding Request form to the EDI Integration team, with technical details from the trading partner. Test cycles must be completed successfully before go-live.

12. Credit Management

Customer credit limits are maintained centrally in SAP S/4HANA by the Sanofi Credit Management team. There is no secondary credit system. The SAP credit limit is the authoritative figure for all order release decisions, regardless of the order channel.

For EDI orders, credit hold status is assessed automatically by SAP on receipt of the ORDERS message. A held order triggers an automated exception flag in the CS worklist. The CS Representative notifies the Credit Controller within four business hours of a credit hold exception.

13. Escalation and Dispute Resolution

13.1 Order Processing Escalation

Level	Role	Escalation Trigger	Target Response
1	CS Representative	Standard order queries within SOP scope.	Immediate.

2	CS Team Lead	Non-standard orders. Queries unresolved at Level 1 in 4 hrs. EDI exceptions unresolved in 4 hrs. Credit holds unresolved.	2 business hours.
3	VP Consumer Healthcare Operations	Strategic account service failure. Revenue impact > EUR 100K. Regulatory or compliance implications.	4 business hours.

13.2 EDI-Specific Escalation

For EDI connection failures affecting order processing, the CS Team Lead has authority to approve a temporary switch to manual/email order processing for the affected account while the EDI incident is being resolved. This decision must be communicated to the Account Manager and documented in SAP.

14. Compliance and Audit

Compliance with this SOP is mandatory. Annual internal audit covers: order confirmation timeliness across all channels, EDI exception resolution times, credit hold governance and release documentation, and SAP order record completeness for non-standard decisions.

This SOP is subject to annual review by the Global Consumer Healthcare Operations team. Changes require sign-off from the VP Consumer Healthcare Operations, Europe.

Appendix A: EDI Active Connection List (EMEA Extract)

The following is a representative extract from the Sanofi Shared Services EDI Connection Register as at January 2023. The full register (34 active connections) is maintained by the EDI Integration team.

#	Market	Trading Partner	Msg Types	Protocol	Annual Vol (EUR M)
1	FR	Carrefour France	ORDERS/ORDRSP/INVOIC	AS2	38.2
2	FR	E.Leclerc	ORDERS/ORDRSP/DESADV	SFTP	22.7
3	UK	Boots UK	ORDERS/ORDRSP/INVOIC	AS2	29.4
4	UK	Tesco UK	ORDERS/ORDRSP/DESADV/	AS2	24.1
5	DE	dm (Drogerie Markt)	ORDERS/ORDRSP	VAN	16.8
6	DE	REWE Group	ORDERS/ORDRSP	AS2	11.2
7	EU	Lidl Europe	ORDERS/ORDRSP	AS2	18.9
8	EU	Alliance Healthcare	ORDERS/DESADV	SFTP	13.4
9	ES	Mercadona	ORDERS/ORDRSP	AS2	9.7
1	EU	Aldi Europe	ORDERS	VAN	8.1
1	BE	Delhaize Group	ORDERS/ORDRSP/INVOIC	AS2	7.3
1	EU	Coop Group	ORDERS/INVOIC	SFTP	6.2
2					

Appendix B: Key Contact Directory (Sanofi CS - EMEA)

Role	Name / Team	Contact
Head of CS Operations, Consumer Healthcare EMEA	A. Laurent	a.laurent@sanofi.com
CS Team Lead, EMEA North (UK/IE)	CS Team UK	cs.uk@sanofi.com
CS Team Lead, EMEA West (FR/BE/NL/LU)	CS Team FR	cs.fr@sanofi.com
CS Team Lead, EMEA Central (DE/AT/CH)	CS Team DE	cs.de@sanofi.com
EDI Integration Lead	Sanofi Shared Services EDI	edi.support@sanofi.com
Sanofi IT Helpdesk (EDI)	IT Helpdesk	+33 1 53 77 40 00, Option 3
Credit Management Team	Credit Management EMEA	credit.emea@sanofi.com